Drone Forensics Toolkit Development

PUSHPAK Grand Challenge 3: Security of Drones, Objective 1

Stage 2 -- Detailed Evidence-Supported Toolkit Report Template

This template is intended for the Stage 2 detailed submission. Teams are expected to go beyond the Stage 1 proof of concept and provide validation evidence, on real and traceable data, that builds confidence the toolkit can be used by an investigator and subsequently tested in the field.

Team and Submission Information

Particular	Details
Team ID	
Team Name	
Date of Submission	
Toolkit Name / Version	

Report Structure and Section Weightage

Section	Weight
1. Executive Toolkit Summary	5
2. Stage 1 Baseline and Design Evolution	8
3. Updated/Implemented Requirements and Architecture	7

4. Integrated Methodology and Workflow	8
5. Evidence Acquisition, Preservation and Chain of Custody	18
6. Parsing, Analysis and Data Extraction	12
7. Timeline, Flight Path and Event Reconstruction	8
8. Validation, Testing and Reproducibility	14
9. Automation, Usability and Reporting	8
10. Final Deployable Package	7
11. References, Data Traceability and Integrity	5
Total	100

Submission note: Keep the main report concise and evidence-driven. Source code, test suites, sample evidence, logs, scripts and the demonstration video must be included in the submitted archive; a link alone is not sufficient. Detailed results, extra plots and raw outputs may be attached as appendices. The emphasis is on traceable methodology, results that come from the submitted code on the data described, and a toolkit an examiner could actually deploy.

1. Executive Toolkit Summary [5 Marks]

Briefly summarise the final Stage 2 toolkit, the major changes from Stage 1, and the level of confidence in the final result.

Parameter	Final Stage 2 Value	Unit	Evidence / Section Reference

Toolkit name and version		--	
Drone platforms / vendors supported		count	
Evidence sources handled (flight-controller log, SD card, eMMC image, remote controller, companion app, media)		count	
File / log formats parsed		count	
Acquisition paths run on real hardware		count	
Acquisition paths run on imported files or images only		count	
Hash algorithms used		--	
Custody record mechanism		--	
Real evidence items processed end to end		count	
Synthetic / generated test items (declared)		count	
Tests included in the submitted archive		count	
Tests passing on a clean-machine run		count	
Own source code size / third-party components		lines / count	

Runs fully offline?		Yes / No	
Report output formats		--	
Time to process the reference case		min	

Top three reasons why the toolkit is considered ready for field testing:

1.

2.

3.

Top three remaining uncertainties or risks:

1.

2.

3.

2. Stage 1 Baseline and Design Evolution [8 Marks]

Do not repeat the complete Stage 1 report. Summarise the baseline, state what changed, and justify each change using Stage 2 testing, validation or engineering judgement.

Item	Stage 1 Value / Approach	Stage 2 Value / Approach	Change Made?	Reason / Evidence
Platforms and vendors supported			Yes / No	
Formats parsed			Yes / No	

Acquisition paths			Yes / No	
Hashing and custody design			Yes / No	
Analysis and correlation capabilities			Yes / No	
Timeline / flight-path reconstruction			Yes / No	
Report outputs			Yes / No	
Test evidence and data used			Yes / No	
Architecture			Yes / No	
Third-party components			Yes / No	

2.1 Stage 1 Claims Revisited

List each capability claimed or planned in Stage 1 and state whether it is now demonstrated.

Stage 1 Claim	Demonstrated / Partly / Withdrawn	Reason	Supporting Evidence

2.2 Stage 1 Open Questions Addressed

Open Question from Stage 1	How Addressed in Stage 2	Result / Evidence	Remaining Uncertainty

3. Updated/Implemented Requirements and Architecture [7 Marks]

Requirement / Target	Challenge Target	Final Team Target	Status / Comment
Acquire evidence	From flight controller, onboard or SD storage, remote controller, companion app and media		
Preserve evidence	Hash at acquisition, verify on every read, detect tampering		
Chain of custody	Tamper-evident record of who did what and when		

Analyse	Extract and interpret flight, event and media data across vendors		
Reconstruct	Timeline and flight path from the evidence		
Report	Examiner-ready, reproducible report		
Vendor independence	Extensible beyond the vendors tested		
Design outcome	Validated, deployable toolkit		

Describe the final toolkit architecture, including acquisition layer, evidence store, parser layer, data model, analysis modules, reporting layer, user interface, and how third-party components are isolated from the team's own code.

Insert final system architecture figure here

4. Integrated Methodology and Workflow [8 Marks]

This section should make the investigative process reproducible. Show how acquisition, integrity checking, parsing, analysis, reconstruction and reporting are linked. Include a logic-flow diagram.

Insert workflow / logic-flow diagram here (acquire, preserve, parse, normalise, analyse, reconstruct, report)

Sub-domain	Tool / Code / Method	Main Inputs	Main Outputs	How Verified / Checked
Acquisition				
Integrity and custody				
Format identification				
Parsing and extraction				
Data model / normalisation				
Analysis and correlation				
Timeline and reconstruction				
Reporting and export				

Explain how results from one stage affect the others, for example how a failed hash check changes what is parsed, or how clock reconciliation changes the reconstructed timeline.

5. Evidence Acquisition, Preservation and Chain of Custody [18 Marks]

This is the most heavily weighted section. A toolkit that cannot demonstrate evidence integrity cannot be considered deployable. Be explicit about what was run on real hardware and what was run on imported files or images.

5.1 Methodology

Item	Details Required
Acquisition paths implemented	List every path (for example SD card, mounted storage image, serial or MAVLink download, eMMC image, remote controller, companion app) and its status
Real hardware versus import	State for each path whether it was exercised on a physical device or only on a file or image supplied to the tool
Write protection	Hardware or software method, and how it was verified that the source was not modified
Hashing	Algorithms, when computed (at read, during copy, on every access), and where the values are stored
Custody record	Fields recorded, append-only or chained design, signing, where it is stored, how tampering is detected
Time source and clock handling	Time base used, device clock versus examiner clock, reconciliation method
Corrupt or partial evidence	How truncated, damaged or unsupported files are handled and reported
Offline operation	Confirm that no network access is needed at run time, and list any step that needs it

Limitations	Known gaps in acquisition and integrity

5.2 Acquisition Matrix

Case	Evidence source / device	Acquisition method	Real or generated?	Hash before / after	Output
1					
2					
3					
4					

5.3 Required Outputs

Output	Required Content
Hash verification	Hash values before and after acquisition for each real evidence item, and a demonstrated mismatch
Tamper test	Alter one byte of an evidence file and one entry of the custody log; show the tool detects both
Custody log	Excerpt from a complete case showing every action, actor, time and hash
Acquisition limits	What the toolkit cannot acquire, and the effect on the evidence

Confidence statement	Why the team trusts the integrity chain, and what it did not test

Insert custody log excerpt and tamper-detection output here

Insert hash verification output for real evidence here

6. Parsing, Analysis and Data Extraction [12 Marks]

Every value shown as evidence must be decoded from the evidence file. Any value that is computed, interpolated, estimated or generated by the tool must be labelled as such in the output and in this report.

6.1 Parser Coverage

Platform / Format	Parser (own or library, licence)	Real sample used (source, size)	Fields decoded	Verified against

6.2 Analysis Capabilities

Capability	Method	Test evidence	Result	Limitation
Deleted-data recovery / carving				
Cross-source correlation				
Anomaly detection (GPS spoofing, jamming, rogue commands)				
Media and metadata extraction				
Mobile / companion-app artefacts				

Insert sample extracted data with source-offset provenance here

7. Timeline, Flight Path and Event Reconstruction [8 Marks]

Describe how the toolkit reconstructs what happened from the evidence and how the reconstruction was checked against a known flight.

Parameter	Value	Unit	Basis / Evidence
Samples reconstructed		count	
Time base and clock reconciliation		--	
Position error against a reference		m	

Events identified		count	
Cross-source alignment error		s	
Visualisation outputs (2D / 3D / timeline)		--	

7.1 Reconstruction Workflow

Input Evidence	Reconstruction Step	Output	Check Against a Known Flight

Insert reconstructed flight path and event timeline here

Explain how the reconstruction was validated, and which parts rest on assumptions.

8. Validation, Testing and Reproducibility [14 Marks]

The committee will re-run the submitted tests on a clean machine. Results that the submitted code and data cannot reproduce will not be credited.

8.1 Test Setup

Item	Details Required

Test framework and location	Framework, number of tests, and where they are in the submitted archive
Evidence corpus	Real versus synthetic items, source and licence of each real item, size, and where it is in the archive (large files must be included or supplied separately with a checksum)
Ground truth	How the correct answer for each test was established
Negative tests	Corrupt, truncated, empty and unsupported inputs
Tamper tests	Modified evidence and modified custody records
Performance	Time and memory on the reference case and on a larger case
Environment	Operating system, language and library versions, offline run
Independent re-run instructions	Exact commands a reviewer can run to reproduce the results

8.2 Results Summary

Test Category	Count	Passed	Failed / Skipped	Cause of Failures	Evidence
Unit tests					
Integration / end-to-end					

Known-answer tests					
Real-data runs					
Tamper and corruption					
Cross-platform					

8.3 Claims Traceability

List every quantitative claim in this report (tests passed, formats supported, accuracy, timings) and show where it can be reproduced.

Claim in this report	Where reproduced (file / test)	Command to reproduce	Result

State the validation conclusion: which capabilities are validated on real data, which only on synthetic data, and which are not yet validated.

9. Automation, Usability and Reporting [8 Marks]

Item	Selected Approach	Evidence
Interface (command line, desktop, web)		
Installation steps and requirements		
Automation / batch processing		
Examiner workflow, case creation to final report		
Report formats (PDF, HTML, CSV, GPX, KML, JSON)		
Court-readiness features (hash appendix, certificate, custody summary)		
Offline operation (maps, models, dependencies)		
Demonstration video (screen recording of a real run)		

Quantity	Value	Unit	Basis
Steps to produce a report from raw evidence		count	
Time for a new examiner to complete the reference case		min	
Install time on a clean machine		min	

Processing time per GB of evidence		min	

Insert examiner workflow screenshots and a sample report page here

10. Final Deployable Package [7 Marks]

Required Item	Submitted? Yes / No	File Name / Section Reference
Complete source code (in the archive)		
Installation and user guide		
Test suite and instructions to run it		
Real sample evidence and ground-truth files		
Pre-generated case outputs and reports		
Custody ledger samples		
Demonstration video (real run)		
Dependency list with licences; third-party code identified		
Architecture and design document		

Risk register		
Known limitations and roadmap		

Readiness Item	Final Value / Status	Evidence
Installs and runs offline from the package on a clean machine?		
Headline tests pass on the committee's re-run?		
Tamper in evidence and custody log detected?		
Real evidence processed end to end?		
Third-party code identified and licensed?		
Ready for a field trial with investigators?		

Final readiness statement: Based on the validation completed, explain why this toolkit should be selected for field trial.

11. References, Data Traceability and Integrity [5 Marks]

No.	Reference / Source	Link / DOI / Datasheet	Application in the Toolkit
1			

2			
3			
4			
5			

11.1 Software, Digital and AI Tools Used

Tool	Purpose	Nature / Extent of Use	Team Verification Performed

11.2 Third-Party Code and Datasets

Name	Licence	What Was Used	Where Credited in this Report

11.3 Design Integrity Declaration

We confirm that the toolkit design, source code, test cases, results and technical decisions presented in this report have been reviewed and verified by the team. Every result shown was

produced by the submitted code on the data described. No value has been generated, simulated or edited to resemble evidence unless it is labelled as such. The team accepts responsibility for the technical accuracy, validity and integrity of the submitted work. The evaluation committee may request the source repository history, test logs, raw evidence, or other technical records, and may require the team to explain, reproduce, modify or defend the technical work presented in this report.

Particular	Details
Team ID	
Team Name	
Team Leader Signature	
Date	

Stage 2 Evaluation Rubric

Criterion	Weight	Expectations
Executive toolkit summary	5	Clear final toolkit and key evidence; concise statement of confidence and limits
Stage 1 traceability and design evolution	8	Changes from Stage 1 are justified by testing, not arbitrary; Stage 1 claims are demonstrated or withdrawn
Updated requirements and architecture	7	Architecture is coherent, integrated and aligned with the challenge needs: acquire, preserve, analyse, report

Integrated methodology and workflow	8	Logical workflow connecting acquisition, integrity, parsing, analysis, reconstruction and reporting
Evidence acquisition, preservation and chain of custody	18	Real acquisition clearly separated from imported files; hash verification and tamper detection demonstrated; custody record is tamper-evident; limits stated. A toolkit that cannot demonstrate evidence integrity cannot be shortlisted
Parsing, analysis and data extraction	12	Parsers decode real data with no generated values presented as evidence; results cross-checked against a reference; deleted-data and cross-source analysis shown; limits documented
Timeline, flight path and event reconstruction	8	Reconstruction checked against a known flight; time base and clock reconciliation explained
Validation, testing and reproducibility	14	Tests and data are in the archive and pass on the committee's re-run; real evidence used; negative and tamper tests; synthetic data labelled; every claim traceable
Automation, usability and reporting	8	An examiner can run the toolkit end to end offline and produce a court-ready report
Final deployable package	7	Source, guides, tests, evidence, ledgers, video and risk register are complete and run on a clean machine
References, traceability and design integrity	5	Sources and third-party code credited and licensed; tools declared and verified; integrity declaration completed

Total	100	

Stage 2 Evaluation Philosophy

- Stage 2 focuses on a validated, working toolkit and the evidence for it, not on a list of features.
- Teams are expected to improve substantially beyond the Stage 1 proof of concept.
- Validation effort should be significant but practical for a two-month team effort.
- A smaller toolkit with traceable results and defensible claims is preferred over a larger one with unproven claims.
- Anything that is not demonstrated is treated as design, not as capability.
- Results that the submitted code and data cannot reproduce on the committee's re-run will not be credited.
- The final output should convince the committee that the toolkit can reasonably proceed to a field trial.